Dog supplement label checklist.

A checklist for reading a dog supplement label that uses the AAFCO model labeling format. AAFCO sets model rules that states and FDA enforce, so details can vary. Keep it open next to the package.

On the front of the package

- [ ] Product name and the species it is for.[1]
- [ ] Net quantity (lower third of the front panel).[1]
- [ ] Purpose statement: on labels using the newer AAFCO format, a supplement reads "Dog Food Supplement" and sits in the lower 30% of the front panel.[2]

On the back or side

- [ ] Guaranteed analysis: the amounts the company guarantees, as minimums or maximums.[1]
- [ ] Ingredient list: ingredients run from most to least by weight, by official or common name.[1, 5]
- [ ] Directions, if the label gives them: how much to give and how often.[1]
- [ ] Company name and address, which may read "manufactured for" if another company makes it.[1]

Keep for later

- [ ] Lot number, if printed (FDA does not require one), and the "best by" date, often printed near each other.[3]
- [ ] Keep the product in its original package, or take a dated photo of the codes.[3]

> **Talk to your vet.** Follow the label directions, and ask your vet how a supplement fits your dog's routine before you start.

Want the reasons behind each item? Read How to read a dog supplement label.

Sources.

1. Association of American Feed Control Officials. Labeling and labeling requirements. AAFCO.
2. Association of American Feed Control Officials. Small Manufacturer Guidance: Purpose Statement and Nutritional Adequacy Claims, Model Regulation PF4. AAFCO, 2025.
3. US Food and Drug Administration, Center for Veterinary Medicine. Save your pet food lot number! FDA, 2024.
4. Association of American Feed Control Officials. Small Manufacturer Guidance: Ingredients, Model Regulation PF6, and Handling and Storage Instructions, PF12. AAFCO, 2025.